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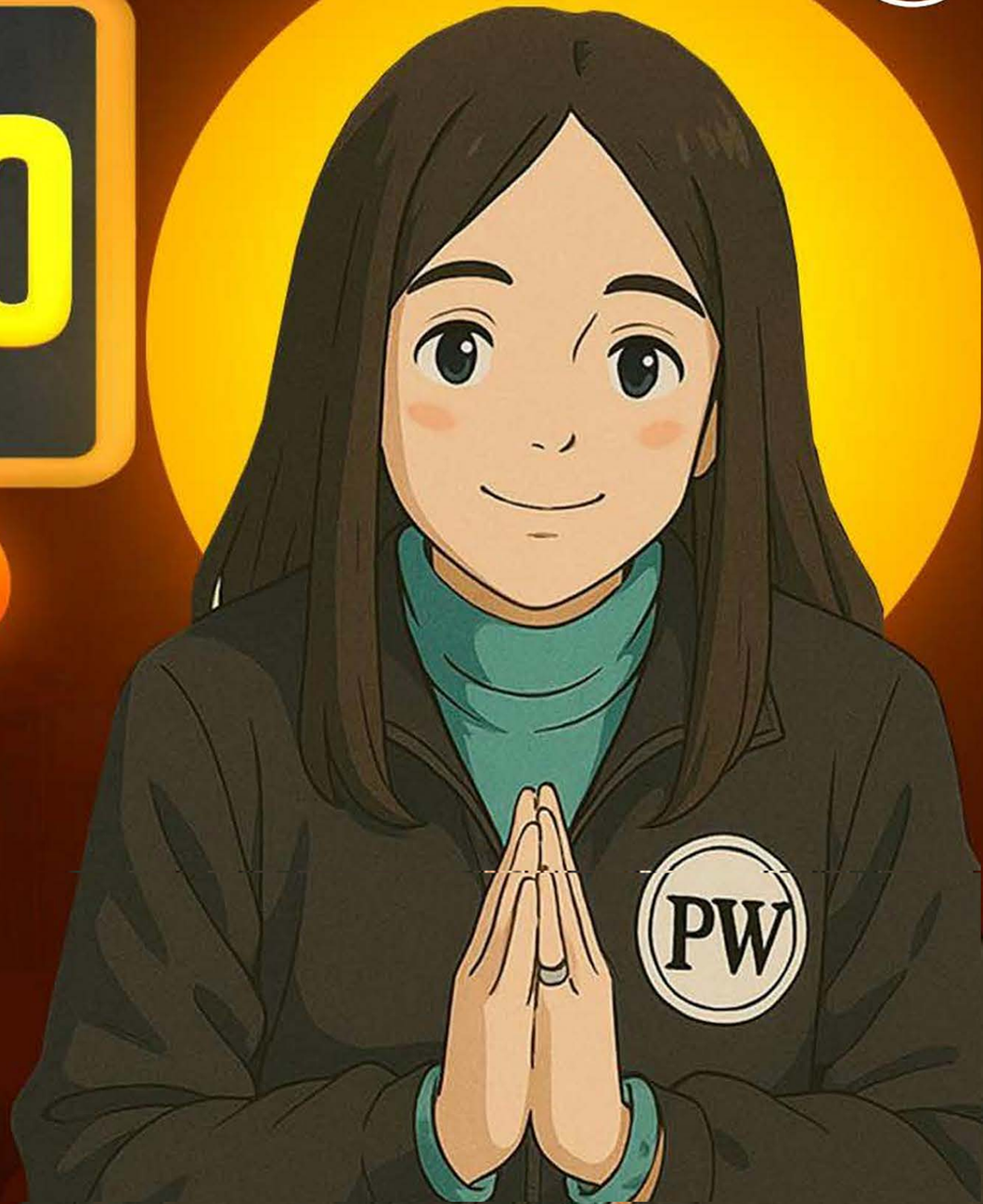
CLASS 12TH 2026

Flamingo - My Mother At Sixty Six



ENGLISH LECTURE 01

By- Niharika Ma'am



TOPICS TO BE COVERED

1 My Mother at 66

- Kamla Das
  - growing up



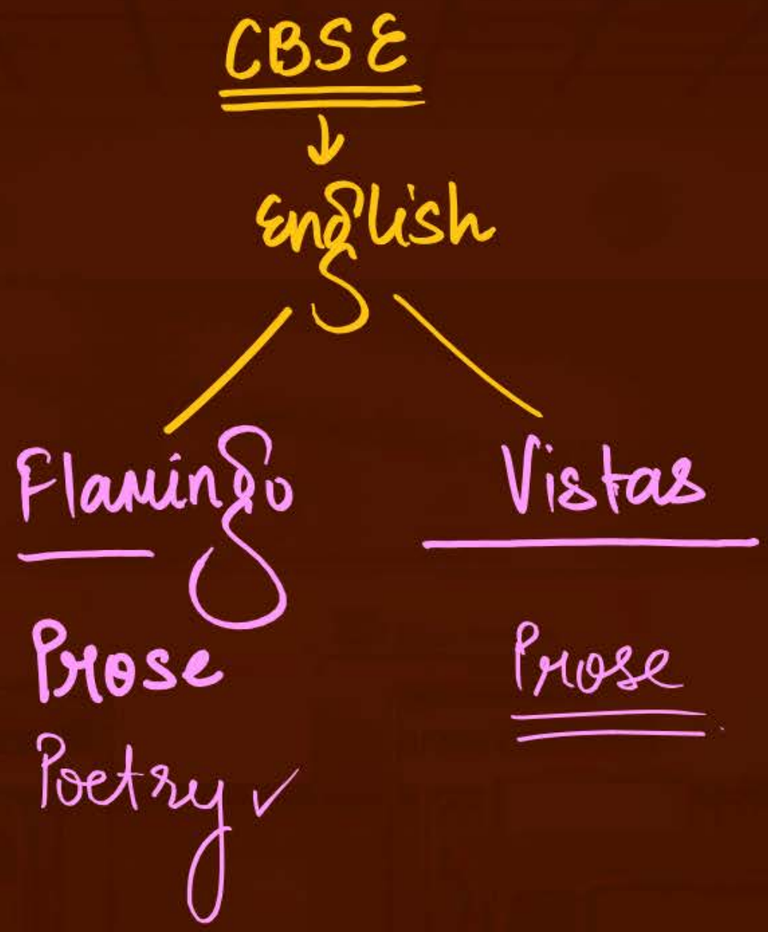

WELCOME TO OUR TEAM
English
Rocket Raccoon
YOU ARE GOING TO LOVE IT HERE!

Welcome

Can’t wait to see you

SHINE

in my Class!


CBSE
English
Flamingo
Prose
Poetry
Vistas
Prose

Notes

I

Summary Notes + Q/A ✓]

Yes

My Mother at Sixty-66



"Her face... ashen like
that of a corpse.'"
(Stillness of age vs motion of life)



I looked again at her, wan,
pale..."
A whole life lived. A silence in breah.



Young trees sprinting,
the merry children spilling
out of their homes...



...see you soon, Amma.
The hardest goodbyes are
the ones you smile through.

— airport



All I did was smile
and smile and smile...

When fear becomes too deep
for words, we wear a smile.

MOTHER'S TRIBUTE

GIVING MOMS THE PROPS THEY DESERVE

BEST MOM EVER!

SHE'S THE BOMB

How much do you love your mom? _____
What's your favorite thing to do with your mom? _____
_____
Why do you love your mom? _____
_____ _____
What is the prettiest thing about your mom? _____
What can you do to help your mom around the house?
_____ _____

A MOM IS NOT "JUST A MOM"

She is also... a chef, housekeeper, babysitter, taxi driver, comedian, therapist, nurse, cheerleader, judge, janitor, party planner, hair stylist, friend, teacher. coach, seamstress, personal shopper, accountant, barber, manicurist. bodyguard, bus driver, comforter, confidant, counselor, trainer, director of research and development, doctor, etiquette advisor, fan, florist, guide, historian, - hostess, interior decorator, Jury, launderer, lead singer, model, painter, police officer, psychic, scheduler, story teller, study hall monitor, supervisor, travel agent, dog walker, pooper scorper, food tester, CEO of house, errand runner, toy repair expert, art director, land scalper, potty trainer, wailers, search and rescue (for lost items), lifeguard, and a daycare provider all in one.

Just incase you didn't already know we really do appreciate all of your hard work and endless love.

Love,



old lady

Kamla Das' Mother

wrinkled face

"The ache
of separation,
felt in the presence
of a loved one.

—*Mother at 66*

Main theme

Topic : My Mother At Sixty-Six

Theme

My Mother at Sixty-Six' captures the fear of the narrator of losing her mother due to declining health and loss of energy which accompanies old age. The poet accepts this reality and is disturbed by her mother's need for her on one hand, and her own duties and responsibilities on the other hand.

This helplessness is poignantly brought out in this poem. The emotions experienced by the poet are essentially universal in nature. The fear of losing a loved one is a theme the reader can identify with.



Topic : My Mother At Sixty-Six

Driving from my parent's home to Cochin last Friday morning,

I saw my mother, beside me,
doze, open mouthed, her face ashen like that
of a corpse and realised with pain

that she was as old as she looked

Topic : My Mother At Sixty-Six

Driving from my parent's home to Cochin last Friday morning,

I saw my mother, beside me,

doze, open mouthed, her face ashen like that

of a corpse and realised with pain

that she was as old as she looked

compared mother to a dead person

dead body

as, like

direct comparison

SIMILIE

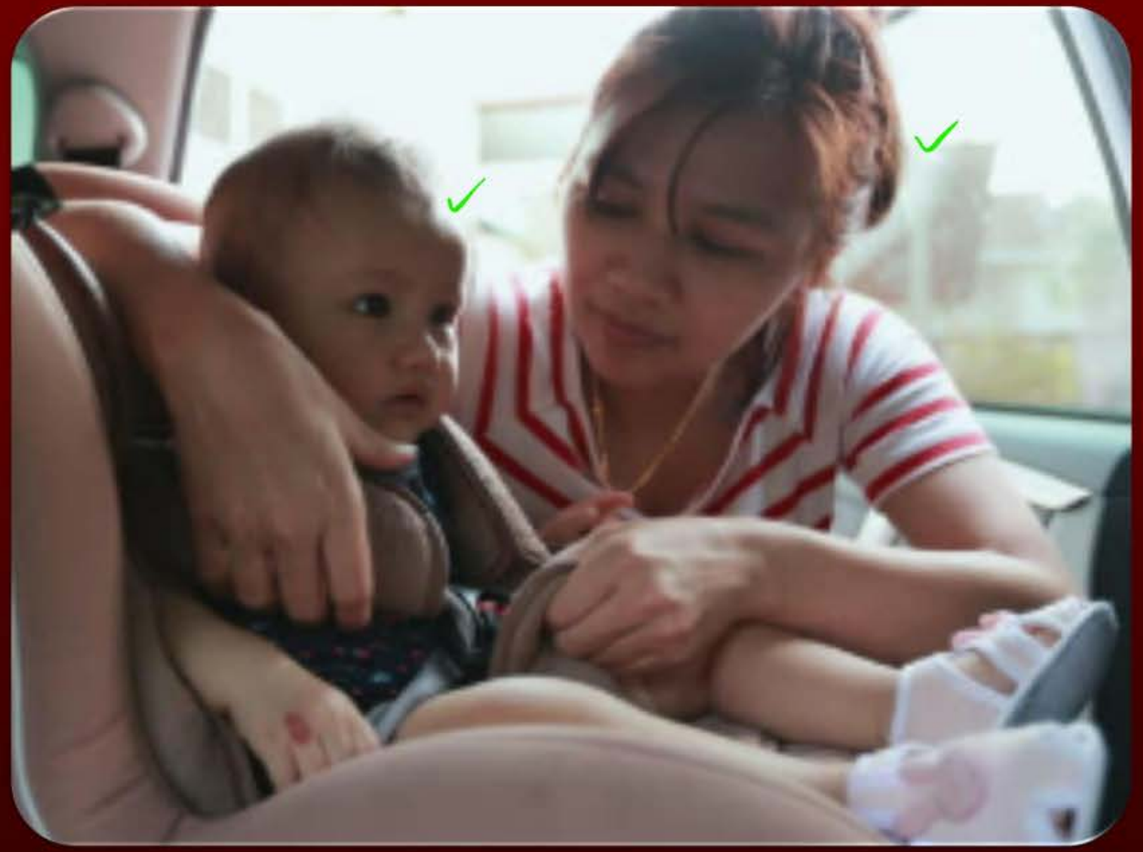
old face, no movement and dullness

Topic : My Mother At Sixty-Six

Explanation:

Addressing the reader, the poet shares her experience about one Friday morning when she was on her way to the airport in Cochin, moving away from her parent's home. Her aged mother was sitting beside her in the car. She noticed that her mother was sleeping with her mouth open.

Her face appeared colourless as if it were of a dead body. A sudden fear and pain gripped the poet and she realized that her mother was actually very old. This also indicated that she might pass away soon. This was a hard to accept reality and its realization was alarming.





Topic : My Mother At Sixty-Six

but soon
escape the reality
put that thought away, and looked out at young
running
trees sprinting, the merry children spilling
→ Imp
out of their homes
happy
coming out

Young Trees
Sprinting
Energetic
Mother
old, not energetic
Sleeping

Merrey children ✓
happy
phase of life
Enthusiastic - active

Mother - last phase ✓ (old Age)
neutral
Sleeping ✓





Topic : My Mother At Sixty-Six

but soon

put that thought away, and looked out at young

trees sprinting, the merry children spilling → बिखरना

out of their homes

Personification
मानवीकरण

Running
↓
Human activity / trait
(खासियत)

spilling of milk ✓
children scattered to play

Comparison
(as / like)
↓
Indirect Metaphor ✓





Topic : My Mother At Sixty-Six

Explanation:

The poet further says that soon she tried to shrug off this negative thought and looked out at nature, perhaps to seek solace. The trees along the road seemed to be hurrying past the speeding car. They were young in contrast to her old mother.

The movement of trees and the speeding car were reminders of the fact that time had flown by The poet also saw some s children who had rushed out of their homes as if something had spill over from a crowded vessel.

This view probably reminded her of her childhood and of the time when her mother was young.

Topic : My Mother At Sixty-Six

final meeting point

but after the airport's → Important point

security check, standing a few yards – looking at her mother

away, I looked again at her, wan, pale – fixed colourless

as a late winter's moon

[as if to capture her



Topic : My Mother At Sixty-Six

but after the airport's → Symbolism - last physical contact

security check, standing a few yards

away, I looked again at her, wan, pale

→ direct comparison - similie

as a late winter's moon

↓

comparison to a moon



Late
↓
who is no more

winter's
↓
last season

Mother - last phase

Moon
↓
dull, unclear
foggy

Mother's future - unclear

Topic : My Mother At Sixty-Six

Explanation:

The poet continues to narrate the event and discloses the scene after she had gone through the security check at the airport.

She looked back at her mother who stood some distance away and looked as dull and lifeless as the late winter's moon. This comparison with a negative object indicates that the scene evoked as la sense of helplessness in the poet.



Topic : My Mother At Sixty-Six

and felt that old familiar ache, my childhood's fear, but all I said was, see you soon, Amma, all I did was smile and smile and smile.....

known pain

of a losing parent ✓ hope of her meeting her again

thunderstorm of thoughts | to hide here pain | positive ending



—X—X—X—

Topic : My Mother At Sixty-Six

and felt that old familiar ache, my childhood's fear, but all I said was, see you soon, Amma, all I did was smile and smile and smile.....

Alliteration

Repetition - emphasis on showing smile and hiding pain



Topic : My Mother At Sixty-Six

Explanation:

She bids farewell to her mother and keeping her hope of seeing her again alive, says “see you soon, Amma”.

She hides her sorrow as she does not want to create a painful environment for her mother and conveys her that as she is enjoying her life similarly her mother should also be happy and enjoy her life. Another plausible reason could be that she didn’t wish to upset her mother.



Topic : My Mother At Sixty-Six

Summary:

Declining health and loss of energy accompanies old age. The narrator accepts this reality and is disturbed by her mother's need for her on the one hand, and her own duties. In the poem the narrator is driving to the airport. The mother is with her. She realizes that her mother is old when the latter dozes off.

The mother is pale and looks like a corpse.



Topic : My Mother At Sixty-Six

This disturbs the narrator, so she looks out of the window. She sees trees which seem to be running (when seen from a moving car) and children running out to play.

These images of energy and vitality are a contrast to her mother who is dozing.



Topic : My Mother At Sixty-Six

Poetic Device

Simile

- In a Simile, a comparison between two distinctly different things is indicated by the word 'like' or 'as'.

Examples:

- **her face ashen like that of a corpse**

  The mother's face was pale and greyish. She seemed to have love all vitality. Such paleness i.e. greyish colour of the skin is usually associated with a sick or a dead body.

Topic : My Mother At Sixty-Six

- **wan, pale as a late winter's moon**

  Words like 'pale' and 'wan' reinforce the idea of pallor lifelessness. Winter symbolises death. Thus, the mother's face is indicative of her very frail health and fast approaching death.

Topic : My Mother At Sixty-Six

Repetition

Poets often repeat single words or phrases, lines, and sometimes even whole stanzas at intervals to create musical effect; to emphasize, a point; to draw readers' attention or to lend unity to a piece.

Example:

- smile and smile and smile

  The repetition of the word 'smile' draws attention to the rather long hollow and artificial smile the poet had to put on to cheer up her mother and to hide her own worry, anxiety and guilt.

Topic : My Mother At Sixty-Six

Images and Symbols

Images and symbols are the objects employed by the poet to convey emotions or feelings.

Examples:

- 'trees sprinting' and 'merry children': symbolic of youth, vigour, vitality, life and growth
- 'winter's moon'; symbolic of death

QUESTION

#Q. What is the kind of pain and ache that the poet feels?

1. Losing her mother ✓
2. Heart attack
3. Headache
4. Children screaming at her



QUESTION

#Q. In which languages has Kamla Das written stories and novels?

1. English and Tamil
2. English and Hindi
3. English and Urdu
4. English and Malayalam



QUESTION

#Q. Why did the poet hide her fear from her mother?

of loosing her mother.

(A)

1. She was afraid that the mother would not be able to bear the pain
2. She feared being scolded by the mother
3. She was not so close to her mother to share her deep emotions
4. All of these



QUESTION

#Q. Why has the poet brought the image of trees and children?

1. She loved nature
2. Her mother was boring
3. She wanted to escape the stress ✓
4. To draw a contrast

We readers drew a contrast
↓
difference



QUESTION

#Q. What does the poet notice outside the car?

1. Sprinting trees and running children
2. Schools and roads
3. Other vehicles
4. Many people on the road



QUESTION

#Q. The childhood fear was the fear of

1. separation from mother ✓ (A)
2. exams
3. medical check-up
4. dental treatment



QUESTION

#Q. She said to her mother

1. goodbye
2. au revoir
3. good morning go.
4. see you soon, Amma



QUESTION

#Q. What was the expression on the narrator's face?

1. Smiling face
2. Angry look
3. Sarcastic expression
4. Frowning face



QUESTION

#Q. Smile and smile and smile is

1. alliteration
2. repetition
3. simile
4. metaphor



QUESTION

#Q. The mood in the last two lines is that of

1. regret
2. guilt
3. acceptance of reality ✓
4. anger

Smile
Smile
Smile

3



QUESTION

#Q. The narrator is only using her smile to

1. cover up her pain
2. make herself happy
3. to make her mother happy
4. to make her father happy



QUESTION

#Q. Kamala Das has successfully drawn comparisons between the

1. children and her mother
2. father and mother
3. uncle and aunt
4. nephew and niece



QUESTION

#Q. Why has the mother been compared to the "late winter's moon"?

Ans. The mother has been compared to the "late winter's moon" to emphasise the degenerative stage of her life. Winter is a symbol of death and pale moon is associated with decay. The mother's pale and wrinkly face, together with her grey hair make her look like a "late winter's moon".



QUESTION

#Q. Do you think the poem reflects on the escapist tendency of the poet?

Ans. The poem does reflect the escapist (भागना) tendency of the poet. Burdened by the weight of pain suffered by her mother, she tries to escape from the realities by looking out of the car. Again, she tries to hide the pangs of sufferings by smiling continuously.



QUESTION

#Q. Bring out the significance of the title "My Mother at Sixty-six".

Ans. The title is very apt as the subject of the poem is the poet's aged and frail mother. It, at once, establishes the context in which Kamala is writing - the mother's unexpressed pain and the poet's worry about her mother's frail health old age and perhaps imminent death.



QUESTION

#Q. What is the kind of pain and ache that the poet feels?

Ans. The emotional pain and ache that the poet feels is due to the realization that her mother has gone old and has become frail and pale like a corpse. She is dependent on her children. The ache also refers to the old familiar ache of the childhood that revisits the poet due to the mother's old age and her approaching end.

weak dull



QUESTION

#Q. Why are the young trees described as 'sprinting'?

Ans. The young trees are personified in the poem. They seem to be running in the opposite direction when seen through the window of the moving car. The movement is juxtaposed with the expression on the mother's face i.e. ashen like a corpse. The movement of the children and the trees is in stark contrast with the stillness associated with the mother.



QUESTION

#Q. Why has the poet brought in the image of the merry children 'spilling out of their homes'?

Ans. The poet highlights the helplessness and frailty of old age with the help of contrasts. The mother dozes off mouth open, whereas the children spilling out of their homes signify movement and energy, enthusiasm and vivacity, which the old people are bereft off.



QUESTION

#Q. Why has the mother been compared to the 'late winter's moon'?

Ans. The mother has been compared to the late winter's moon which is dull and shrouded. It symbolizes the ebbing of life. The moon brings to the poets mind night or the approaching end of life. The mother like the late winter's moon is dull, dim and dismal.



QUESTION

#Q. What do the parting words of the poet and her smile signify?

Ans. The parting words 'see you soon Amma' are used by the poet to reassure the mother and to infuse optimism in the poet herself. The poet accepts the reality yet keeps up the façade of smiling in order to put up a brave front. It requires a lot of effort and hence the poet has used the poetic device of repetition.

give positivity

fake look

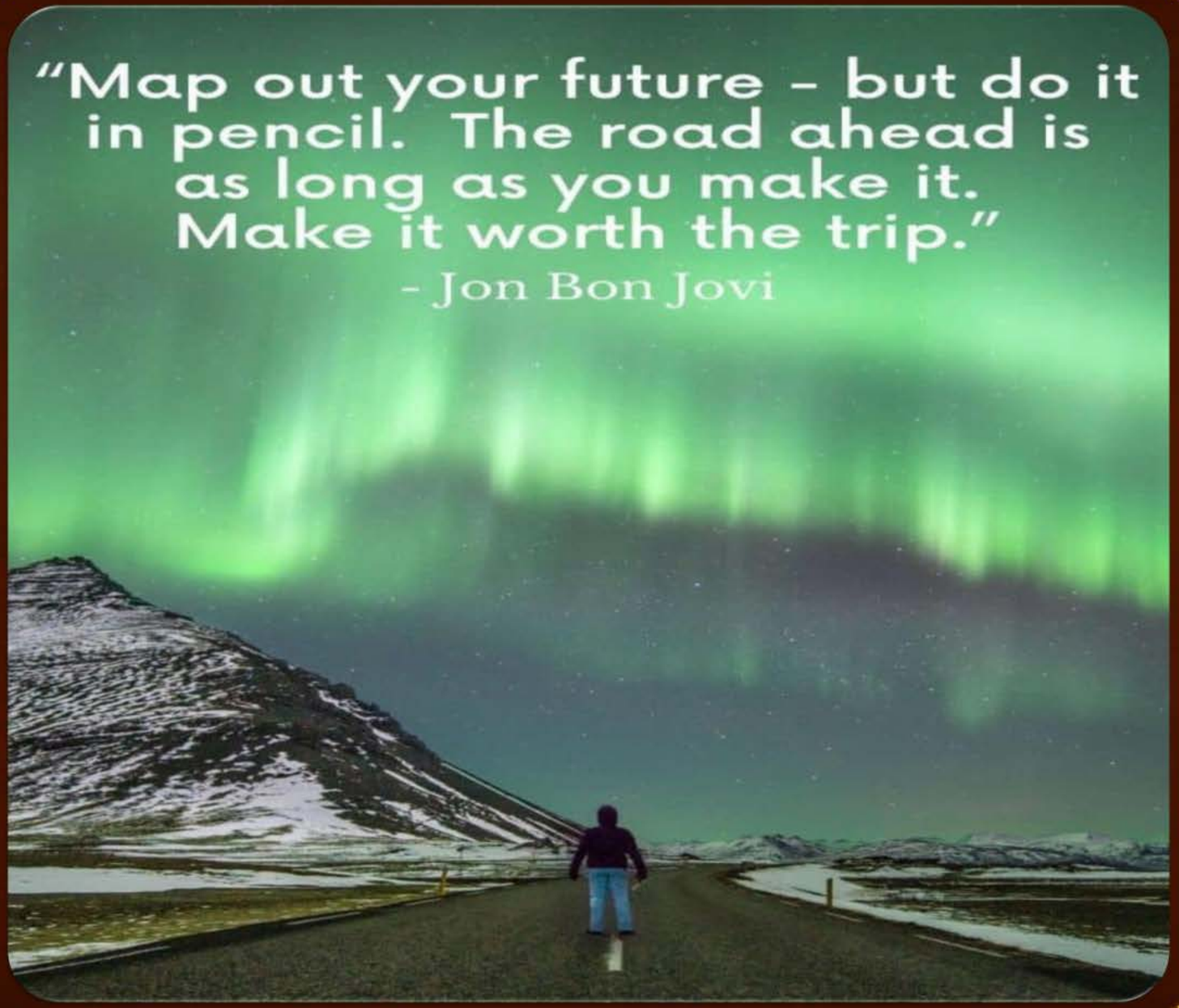


- Her Worth -

Moms give up so much;
sleep, hot meals, tea, baths,
'me' time, beauty – yet they are
often told 'not enough.'

Let's pause and recognize her
sacrifices & remind her that
she is 'more than enough'!

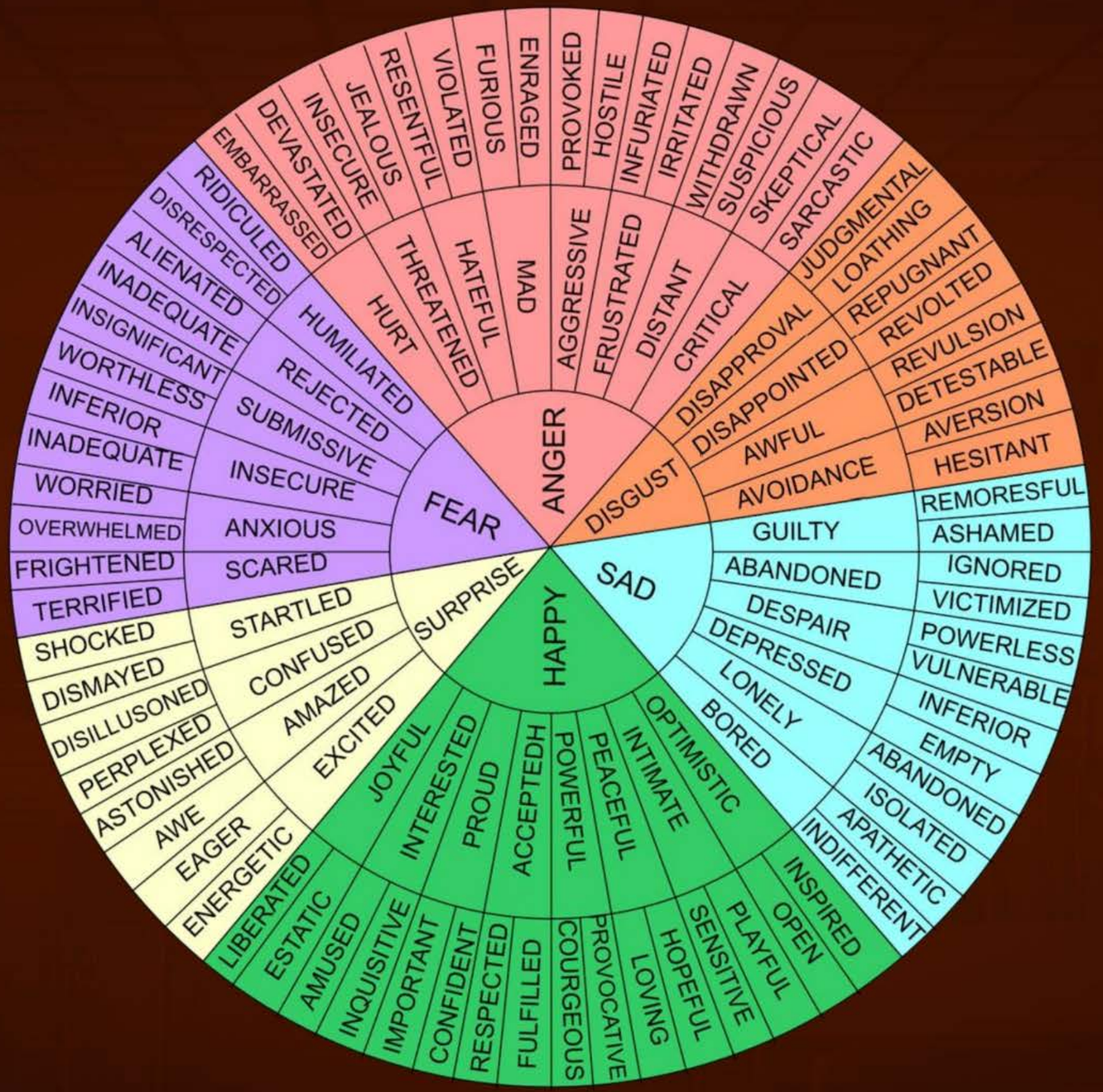




Quote of the day

QOD


BYE, BYE.


ANGER
HURT
EMBARRASSED
DEVASTATED
INSECURE
JEALOUS
RESENTFUL
VIOLATED
FURIOUS
ENRAGED
THREATENED
RIDICULED
DISRESPECTED
ALIENATED
HATEFUL
PROVOKED
HOSTILE
INFURIATED
IRRITATED
WITHDRAWN
SUSPICIOUS
SKEPTICAL
SARCASTIC
MAD
HUMILIATED
REJECTED
SUBMISSIVE
AGGRESSIVE
FRUSTRATED
DISTANT
CRITICAL
JUDGMENTAL
LOATHING
REPUGNANT
REVOLTED
REVULSION
DETESTABLE
AVERSION
HESITANT
FEAR
INADEQUATE
INSIGNIFICANT
WORTHLESS
INFERIOR
INADEQUATE
WORRIED
OVERWHELMED
FRIGHTENED
TERRIFIED
INSECURE
ANXIOUS
SCARED
DISGUST
DISAPPROVAL
DISAPPOINTED
AWFUL
AVOIDANCE
SURPRISE
STARTLED
CONFUSED
AMAZED
EXCITED
SHOCKED
DISMAYED
DISILLUSONED
PERPLEXED
ASTONISHED
AWE
EAGER
ENERGETIC
SAD
GUILTY
ABANDONED
DESPAIR
DEPRESSED
LONELY
BORED
REMORESFUL
ASHAMED
IGNORED
VICTIMIZED
POWERLESS
VULNERABLE
INFERIOR
EMPTY
ABANDONED
ISOLATED
APATHETIC
INDIFFERENT
HAPPY
JOYFUL
INTERESTED
PROUD
ACCEPTEDH
POWERFUL
PEACEFUL
INTIMATE
OPTIMISTIC
INSPIRED
OPEN
PLAYFUL
SENSITIVE
HOPEFUL
LOVING
PROVOCATIVE
COURGEOUS
FULFILLED
RESPECTED
CONFIDENT
IMPORTANT
INQUISITIVE
AMUSED
ESTATIC
LIBERATED

THANK YOU